

Brent Butkow

Software Engineer

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OVERVIEW

I'm a software engineer at Foodcomply, building and designing food-safety compliance software, mostly in TypeScript - React frontends, Node services, CI/CD and infrastructure - and working directly with clients, from demos to on-site onboarding. Before this I spent a year at Entelect, which I joined through their graduate program straight out of an Information Engineering degree at Wits, graduated with distinction. Outside of work I build things for the fun of it, like a live food-recall tracker, a set of 50+ online utilities, and a browser space game on an engine I wrote from scratch.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer, Foodcomply – Johannesburg April 2026 – Present

- Own technical decisions across the platform, from architecture and security to releases.
- Build food-safety compliance software across the stack: React/TypeScript frontends, Node/TypeScript services, and Supabase.
- Designed and built core systems solo, including a redesigned permissions system with granular access control across the whole product, and the CAPA (corrective and preventive action) module.
- Set up the infrastructure and delivery foundations: backups, a separate test environment, a production deployment flow, environment management, and CI pipelines.
- Combine technical delivery with customer-facing work: sales meetings, product demonstrations, requirements gathering, solution design, and onboarding clients on site.
- Side role as Head of Culture: team lunches, team builds, and office snacks.

Software Engineer, Entelect – Johannesburg January 2025 – March 2026

- Joined through the graduate program; after two months moved onto client work at RGA, completing their bootcamp (regarded as the best in South Africa).
- Developed full-stack features in React and TypeScript across client products and services.
- Reduced AWS cloud costs by almost 50% across multiple products.
- Created, deployed, and monitored new environments, services, and products; improved the stability and ease of use of pipelines and the deployment process.
- Added tracing and telemetry via Datadog to APIs and services to track performance and errors.
- Tech accelerator: built Starwright, a browser space game in pure TypeScript on Forge, an open-source game engine I helped build.

Intern, Entelect – Amsterdam Jan – Feb 2024

- Built a virtual-doorbell web app for office access with Azure AD auth and presence calendar (JavaScript, WebSocket, Express, Prisma).

Earlier internships 2021 – 2023

- Stream (VATIT): automated sales/revenue data pipeline and dashboards (DBT, AWS DMS, Lambda, Redshift, QuickSight).
- Business Science Corporation: AI chatbot on Microsoft Teams (Azure, Python, Bot Framework, LUIS).

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Recall Radar – brentbutkow.me/projects/recall-radar – live

- A live food-recall dashboard tracking the US, Canada, UK, and South Africa: daily ingestion from five regulators, ML hazard classification, severity scores, trend analysis, and free email alerts. Python/FastAPI backend, React/TypeScript frontend.

Nimble Toolbox – nimbletoolbox.com – live

- 50+ browser tools (PDF, image, text, and developer utilities) that run entirely client-side, so files never leave the visitor's device. Static Astro site with Preact islands and WebAssembly for PDF processing, designed around search traffic and hosted on Cloudflare.

brentbutkow.me – personal site – ongoing

- Portfolio with browser games and experiments, including Null Space, a space-defense game on a custom TypeScript canvas engine (React 18, TypeScript, Vite, full unit-test suite).

EDUCATION

BSc (Eng) Information Engineering, University of the Witwatersrand

2021 – 2024

- Graduated with distinction. Software Development III: 95%.
- Matric (IEB, 2020): 8 subject distinctions, 91% average.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- Represented South Africa at the International Olympiad in Informatics (IOI), Singapore.
- Top 3 nationally (silver medal), Final Round of the Programming Olympiad.
- Won the Entelect Challenge 2025 (company-wide coding competition).
- Wits Isazi award, twice (top 5 Information Engineers); Wits Entelect award (top Software Development III student).
- Entrostat Prize for the best Software Development III project.

SKILLS

Languages & frameworks: TypeScript, React, Node.js, Python, SQL, C++, C#, Java

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, Terraform, Jenkins, CI/CD, Datadog, Supabase

Other: Git, FastAPI, DBT, game engines (Forge, custom canvas engine)

Human languages: English (first language), Afrikaans (conversational)

REFERENCES

Available on request.